AHEAD WITH KK

Let them touch it: a guide to trials, samples and demos

for shops, salons, cafes, software, coaching

> **What I saw.** In a Bangalore mall: a shop with iPads, MacBooks and AirPods out on open tables, nothing behind glass, and massage chairs in the walkway that people tried for free.

Research says. Just touching a product makes people feel it's theirs (Peck and Shu, Journal of Consumer Research, 2009). And once something feels like yours, you want more to give it up (the endowment effect, Kahneman, Knetsch and Thaler, 1990).

☐ 1. Pick one thing people can hold

- Shop: your bestseller out of the packaging, at hand height.
- Food: a tasting spoon.
- Service: a free 10 minute version (a hair wash, a trial class, a skin check).
- Software or online: a free trial or a demo with their own data.

☐ 2. Put it where people stop

- Near the entrance, near billing, or where the queue forms.

☐ 3. Let them hold it a bit longer

- Don't rush to take it back. Talk about what they'll use it for.

☐ 4. Then ask for the sale

- "Shall I pack this one?" A trial without an ask is a free gift.

☐ 5. Track it

- How many who tried, how many bought. Compare to those who didn't try.

Practical steps, not guaranteed results.